

Hemiscus marmoratus

Mottled shovel-nosed frog



Length 1¼–1½ in (3–4 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Least concern

Location W. and C. to S.E. Africa



Unusually for a burrowing frog, this squat species digs into soil head first, using its sharp, tough, spadelike snout, rather than digging backward with its hind feet. It preys on ants and termites. Females lay up to 2,000 eggs in underground chambers close to pools. They guard the eggs until they hatch, then dig a tunnel to release the tadpoles into the water.



plump body

Hyperolius marmoratus

Painted reed frog



Length 1–1½ in (2.5–3.5 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Spring and
season summer
Status Least concern

Location E. to S.E. Africa



The painted reed frog is a small, graceful animal with highly variable coloration—it may be striped, spotted, or plain brown. A good climber, its fingers and toes are equipped with adhesive disks as well as webbing. It inhabits areas close to permanent ponds, lakes, and swamps; like most frogs, it spends dry spells hidden under logs and rocks. Active at night, it feeds on insects and other invertebrates. During its long breeding season, which extends through spring and summer, males form choruses close to ponds, and call very loudly to attract mates. Females may come to the chorus more than once in a season, laying a clutch of eggs in small clumps in water at each visit. Males vary in the number of nights they spend in a chorus; those that call on the greatest number of nights get the most matings.

Arixalus fornasinii

Greater leaf-folding frog



Length 1¼–1½ in (3–4 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Spring and
season summer
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Africa



Many tree frogs lay their eggs above the ground, but this species has a particularly skillful technique. The female lays her clutch on a leaf overhanging water, and then folds the

leaf, fastening it with a glue that she secretes. When the eggs hatch, the tadpoles drop into the water below—a system that gives them a head start in the struggle to avoid being eaten. Greater leaf-folding frogs are brown with dark, longitudinal stripes, and have slender limbs with adhesive disks as well as webbing on their fingers and toes. They live in dense vegetation around pools and swamps, and are active at night. At the onset of the breeding season, large males call from an elevated position in vegetation, making rapid clicks to attract mates. However, smaller males often stay silent, waiting by the callers. When females approach, the noncalling males sometimes manage to intercept them and mate.



long limbs

pale stripes along back

Kassina senegalensis

Bubbling kassina



Length 1¼–2 in (3–5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Least concern

Location W. and C. to S.E. Africa



Adapted for walking rather than hopping, the bubbling kassina has slender limbs and slight webbing on the toes of its hind feet. Its plump, elongated body varies in color from

beige or yellow to gray, with bold, dark brown or black stripes and blotches. An inhabitant of low-lying savanna and sand dunes, it lives close to ponds and pools. In the breeding season, males begin calling in late afternoon away from water. By nightfall, they have moved closer to call from the pond edge. Mating occurs in water, and the eggs are attached individually to aquatic plants, often in clusters.

*Rhacophorus nigropalmatus*

Wallace's flying frog



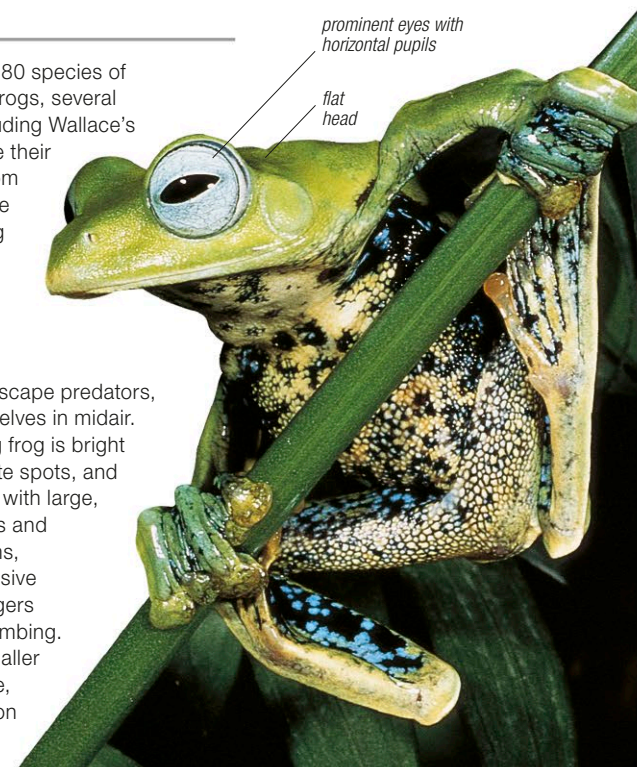
Length 2¾–4 in (7–10 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Asia



There are over 80 species of *Rhacophorus* frogs, several of which—including Wallace's flying frog—use their feet to glide from tree to tree. The partial webbing between their toes acts as a parachute, enabling them to “fly” across wide gaps to escape predators, steering themselves in midair. Wallace's flying frog is bright green with white spots, and has a flat head with large, protruding eyes and visible eardrums, and large adhesive disks on its fingers and toes for climbing. The male is smaller than the female, and has pads on his thumbs so that he can

grasp her during mating. Active at night, Wallace's flying frog is found mostly in brush and forest, and is also frequently found close to human habitation. During the breeding season, the female lays up to 800 eggs in a foam nest attached to foliage overhanging water. When the eggs hatch, the tadpoles emerge and fall into the water below.



prominent eyes with horizontal pupils

flat head

Leptopelis modestus

African treefrog



Length 1–1¼ in (2.5–4.5 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Spring and
season summer
Status Least concern

Location W. Africa, central E. Africa



Also called the modest treefrog, this species has a broad head with a wide mouth, large eyes, and conspicuous eardrums. Gray or pale brown, it has a darker hourglass-

shaped patch on its back. Males call to females from trees, producing a deep “clacking” sound while displaying their bright blue or green throat. They will fight to defend their calling positions.



forward-pointing eyes

long limbs